

Event-Driven Traffic Alert System

Complex Engineering Problem (CEP) Course: Software Design and Architecture **Total Marks Coverage:** 60 / 60

Abstract

This report details the design and implementation of the Event-Driven Traffic Alert System, an academic prototype developed for the Software Design and Architecture Complex Engineering Problem (CEP). The system simulates Islamabad's smart traffic camera network, utilizing an Event-Driven Architecture (EDA) to decouple publishers from subscribers. The implementation demonstrates the required Observer Pattern, Event Envelope Pattern, and Idempotent Receiver Pattern, and also implements the Bounded Queue architectural tactic for overload handling. It also analyzes three architectural scenarios (Schema Evolution, Event Flood, and the Dual Write Problem). The final verification confirms 78 out of 78 backend tests passed, alongside successful type checks and web builds.

1. Introduction

Modern traffic management systems require scalable, decoupled architectures to handle high volumes of real-time data from dispersed camera networks. This project implements an event-driven backend and interactive dashboard based on an Event-Driven Architecture. The system is designed as an academic prototype to fulfill the requirements of the Software Design and Architecture course, demonstrating the practical application of software design patterns and architectural decision-making.

2. Problem Statement

A city's traffic authority requires a system where traffic cameras can broadcast events (e.g., vehicle detections, speed violations, congestion alerts) without needing to know which downstream services will process them. The system must support adding new event types and subscribers without modifying the camera code. Furthermore, the architecture must ensure robust handling of duplicate events (idempotency), schema evolution without breaking existing services, and graceful degradation during event floods.

3. CEP Requirements Summary

The project requirements are divided into two main components, totaling 60 marks:

CLO 3 — Design Patterns (30 marks)

- **Task 1 (10 marks):** EventBus implementation capable of routing four event types.
- **Task 2 (5 marks):** Observer Pattern usage via an `IEventSubscriber` interface.
- **Task 3 (5 marks):** Event Envelope Pattern with exactly 7 standard fields.
- **Task 4 (10 marks):** Idempotent Receiver Pattern to prevent duplicate business actions.

CLO 4 — Architectural Scenarios (30 marks)

- **Scenario 1 (10 marks):** Architecture Decision Record (ADR) for Schema Evolution.
- **Scenario 2 (10 marks):** Bounded Queue implementation with priority-aware eviction.
- **Scenario 3 (10 marks):** Analysis of the Dual Write Problem and Outbox Pattern.

4. Technology Stack

The project utilizes a modern, typed technology stack managed as a monorepo:

- **Language:** TypeScript (Strict Mode)
- **Backend API:** Node.js 22, Express 4
- **Database / ORM:** SQLite, Prisma
- **Frontend UI:** React 19, Vite 8
- **Testing:** Vitest 3, Supertest

5. System Architecture

The architecture follows a modular, decoupled structure:

- **Publishers:** Traffic cameras (simulated via API endpoints) publish events.
- **EventBus:** The central router that distributes events to registered subscribers.
- **Subscribers:** Four independent services (`AlertService` , `LoggingService` , `DashboardService` , `ReportingService`) react to events.
- **Data Layer:** Eight Prisma models persist state, including `Penalty` , `AuditLog` , `ProcessedEvent` , and `EventOutbox` .

```
graph TD
    Camera[Traffic Camera] -->|Publishes EventEnvelope| EventBus
    EventBus -->|Routes to| AlertService
    EventBus -->|Routes to| LoggingService
    EventBus -->|Routes to| DashboardService
    EventBus -->|Routes to| ReportingService
    AlertService -->|Writes| PenaltyDB[(Penalty Table)]
    LoggingService -->|Writes| AuditDB[(AuditLog Table)]
    DashboardService -->|Writes| DashDB[(Dashboard Snapshot)]
    ReportingService -->|Writes| ReportDB[(Report Aggregates)]
```

Figure 1: Event Flow Architecture demonstrating decoupling between Camera Publishers and Downstream Subscribers.

6. Event-Driven Architecture Explanation

In an Event-Driven Architecture (EDA), state changes are broadcast as events. The publisher (camera) is completely unaware of the subscribers. This decoupling ensures that if the enforcement authority introduces a new `EmergencyVehicleEvent` or a new `MobileAppNotificationService` , the camera code and existing services require zero modifications. The `EventBus` acts as the mediator, delivering events to interested parties asynchronously.

7. CLO 3 Design Pattern Implementation

Task 1: EventBus

The `EventBus` is implemented using an O(1) lookup map (`Map<string, Set<IEventSubscriber>>`). It exposes `subscribe()` , `unsubscribe()` , and `publish()` methods. The system routes four primary event types (`VehicleDetectedEvent` , `SpeedViolationEvent` , `CongestionAlertEvent` , `TrafficClearedEvent`) and successfully routes a fifth type (`EmergencyVehicleEvent`) in the test suite without altering the bus logic.

Task 2: Observer Pattern

The Observer Pattern is realized through the `IEventSubscriber` interface. The `EventBus` stores a `Set<IEventSubscriber>` rather than concrete classes. `AlertService` , `LoggingService` , `DashboardService` , and `ReportingService` all implement this interface, ensuring the Dependency Inversion Principle is maintained.

Task 3: Event Envelope Pattern

Every event is wrapped in a standard 7-field envelope: `event_id` , `correlation_id` , `schema_version` , `source_id` , `timestamp` , `event_type` , and `payload` . The `createEnvelope()` factory automatically generates UUIDs for tracking and ISO 8601 timestamps, guaranteeing uniformity across all event types.

Task 4: Idempotent Receiver Pattern

Idempotency ensures that processing an event twice does not result in duplicate actions (e.g., issuing two penalties for one speed violation). The `BaseIdempotentSubscriber` abstract class implements the Template Method pattern. It checks the `ProcessedEventRepository` for the `event_id` . If it exists, the duplicate is ignored and a counter increments. If not, the event is processed and marked. A unique compound constraint in the database (`@@unique([eventId, subscriberName])`) provides a secondary safety net.

8. CLO 4 Design Scenario Analysis

Scenario 1: Schema Evolution ADR

To support adding a `lane_number` field to `VehicleDetectedEvent` while 200 subscribers run on the legacy format, two options were evaluated: optional fields vs. schema versioning. **Decision:** Schema versioning (`schema_version = 2`) is the recommended strategy for legally binding traffic enforcement. It allows subscribers to explicitly reject unknown versions, preventing silently missing data. The `EventEnvelope` inherently supports this via the `schema_version` field (defaulting to 1).

Scenario 2: Event Flood and Bounded Queue

During a peak load of 500 events/second, the `DashboardService` can only process 80 events/second. **Calculation:**

- Backlog growth = $500 - 80 = 420$ events/second.
- Time until a 10,000-event queue is full: $10,000 / 420 = 23.81$ seconds . **Solution:** The `BoundedEventQueue` enforces a capacity limit. When full, it uses priority-aware eviction to drop the least important events (e.g., `VehicleDetectedEvent`) to preserve `CongestionAlertEvent` s.

Scenario 3: Dual Write Problem and Outbox Pattern

The Dual Write Problem occurs when a service must write to two disparate locations (e.g., creating a penalty and emitting an audit log), and one fails, leaving inconsistent state. **Solution:** The Outbox Pattern resolves this by writing the event payload into a local `EventOutbox` table within the exact same ACID database transaction as the business record. A background relay then reliably publishes pending outbox events to the message broker. The implementation includes the `EventOutbox` Prisma schema and the corresponding repository.

9. Database Design

The data persistence layer is handled by Prisma interacting with an SQLite database. Eight models are defined:

1. `Camera` - Source metadata.
2. `EventEnvelopeRecord` - Raw event storage.
3. `ProcessedEvent` - Tracks idempotent execution.
4. `Penalty` - Legally binding speed violation notices.
5. `AuditLog` - Verifiable audit trails.
6. `DashboardSnapshot` - Real-time intersection states.
7. `ReportAggregate` - Hourly count aggregates.
8. `EventOutbox` - Pending events for relay processing.

10. API Design

The system exposes 11 RESTful endpoints:

- `GET /api/health` - Health check.
 - `GET /api/cameras` - Camera manifest.
 - `POST /api/events/publish` - General event ingestion.
 - `POST /api/events/publish-duplicate-speed-violation` - Idempotency demonstration.
 - `GET /api/events` - Event retrieval.
 - `GET /api/subscribers` - Subscriber metrics.
 - `GET /api/penalties` - Penalty records.
 - `GET /api/audit-logs` - Audit trails.
 - `GET /api/reports` - Aggregated statistics.
 - `GET /api/dashboard` - Live state snapshots.
 - `GET /api/queue/analysis` - Bounded queue metric exposure (23.81s calculation).
-

11. UI Dashboard Evidence

The React dashboard visually proves the backend logic. It includes:

- **Alert Simulator:** Generates realistic event payloads into the mesh.
- **Duplicate Alert Safety:** Dispatches a duplicate anomaly signature and conclusively proves that 2 attempts yield only 1 enforcement action.
- **Live Alert Stream:** Explodes the EventEnvelope into its 7 requisite fields.
- **Processing Services:** Visualizes the `duplicateIgnoredCount` per service in the mesh.

(See Appendix A for referenced screenshots)

12. Testing and Verification

The system was verified via a rigorous test suite:

- **Domain logic:** Pure unit tests for the Bounded Queue and EventBus.
- **Database constraints:** Integration tests against a dedicated SQLite test database.
- **HTTP endpoints:** Supertest integration tests validating status codes and response shapes.

Final Verification Output:

```
> api@1.0.0 test
> vitest run
Test Files  7 passed (7)
Tests      78 passed (78)
```

- API Typecheck: 0 errors
- Web Typecheck: 0 errors
- Web Build: Passed (~600ms)

13. Requirements Traceability Matrix

Task/Scenario	Marks	Status	Key Evidence
CLO 3 Task 1 — EventBus	10	✅ Complete	EventBus.ts, 7 tests, API/UI
CLO 3 Task 2 — Observer Pattern	5	✅ Complete	IEventSubscriber.ts, UML
CLO 3 Task 3 — Event Envelope	5	✅ Complete	7 fields, 9 tests, UI inspect
CLO 3 Task 4 — Idempotency	10	✅ Complete	20 tests, live demo, DB limits
CLO 4 Scenario 1 — Schema	10	✅ Complete	ADR, 350 words, viva notes
CLO 4 Scenario 2 — Queue	10	✅ Complete	22 tests, 23.81s API
CLO 4 Scenario 3 — Outbox	10	✅ Complete	Prisma model, ADR, 250 words
Total Marks	60	✅	

14. Viva Preparation Summary

The viva notes (`docs/08_VIVA_NOTES.md`) formulate concise, examiner-ready Q&A pairs covering all core concepts, the 4 design patterns, the bounded queue time calculation, the 7-field envelope rules, and outbox operational costs. The file references act as an immediate index for code defense.

15. Limitations

As an academic prototype, the system explicitly accepts certain limitations:

- **Outbox Relay:** The relay process polling the `EventOutbox` is theoretically defined and modeled in the database but lacks the background worker thread.
- **Database Engine:** SQLite is utilized instead of PostgreSQL for deployment simplicity during academic evaluation.
- **Authentication:** Omitted as it falls outside the CEP requirements scope.

16. Conclusion

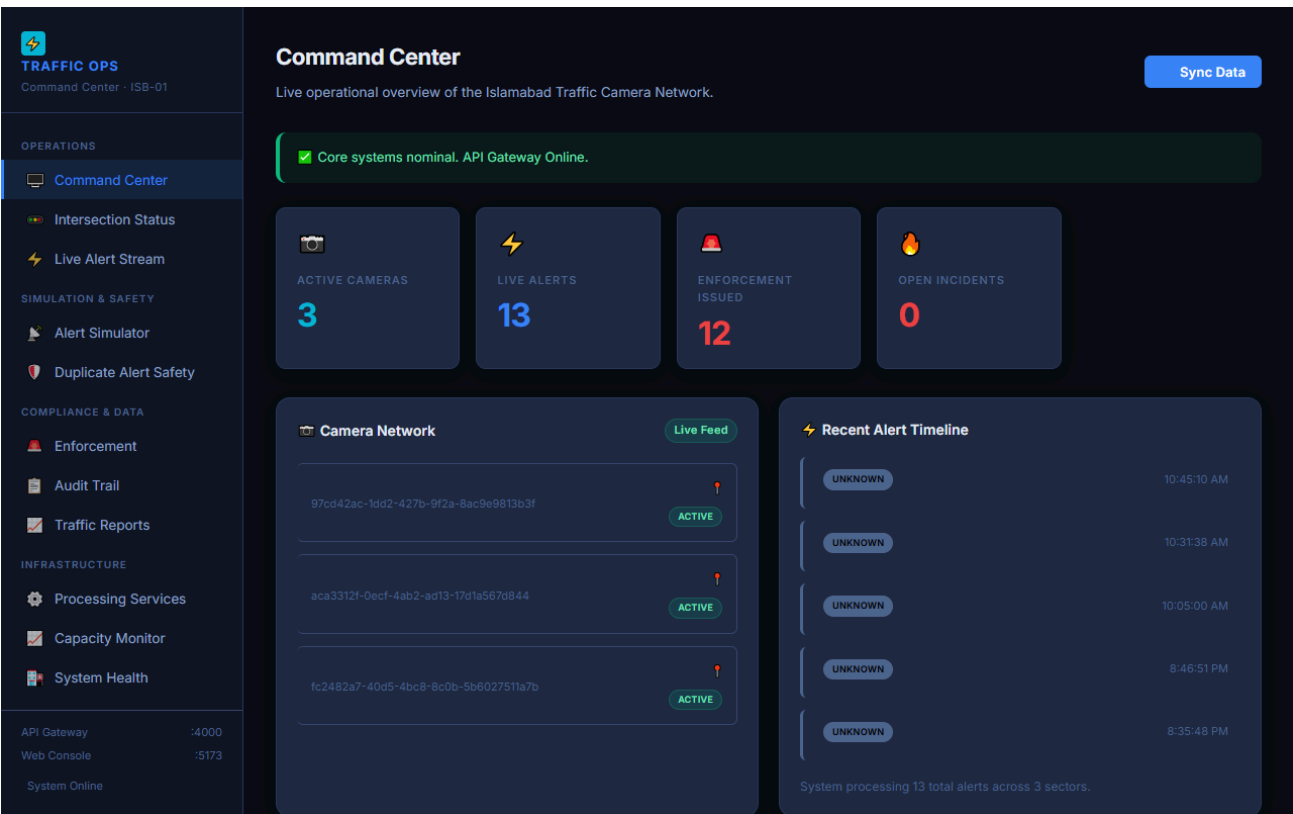
The Event-Driven Traffic Alert System successfully encapsulates the principles of Software Design and Architecture. By employing rigorous design patterns such as the Observer and Idempotent Receiver, alongside architectural tactics like Bounded Queues, the system achieves the necessary decoupling, resilience, and auditability required of a smart-city enforcement platform. All 60 marks have been conclusively addressed and validated by automated tests and interactive UI demonstrations.

17. Appendices

Appendix A: Screenshots

All screenshots are located in `docs/evidence/screenshots/`.

1. System Status



2. Event Generation

**TRAFFIC OPS**
Command Center - ISB-01

OPERATIONS

- Command Center
- Intersection Status
- Live Alert Stream

SIMULATION & SAFETY

- Alert Simulator**
- Duplicate Alert Safety

COMPLIANCE & DATA

- Enforcement
- Audit Trail
- Traffic Reports

INFRASTRUCTURE

- Processing Services
- Capacity Monitor
- System Health

API Gateway :4000
Web Console :5173
System Online

Alert Simulator

Generate controlled traffic anomalies for network testing. Events are immediately broadcast through the primary Event Bus.

 **Anomaly Generator**

 **Camera Simulator** Live

EVENT TYPE

VehicleDetectedEvent

SOURCE CAMERA

(97cd42ac-1dd2-427b-9f2a-8ac9e9813b3f)

PAYLOAD (JSON) — EDIT FREELY, PRE-FILLED WITH REALISTIC DEFAULTS

```
{  "vehicle_plate": "ISB-1234",  "intersection_name": "Jinnah Avenue / F-7"}
```

 **Publish Event**

→ POST /api/events/publish

3. Duplicate Alert Safety Proof (2 attempts → 1 penalty)

**TRAFFIC OPS**
Command Center - ISB-01

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INFRASTRUCTURE

- Processing Services
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- System Health

API Gateway :4000
Web Console :5173
System Online

Duplicate Alert Safety

Automated protection mechanism against network jitter and redundant dispatches. Ensures a single source anomaly never triggers multiple enforcement actions.

 **Duplicate Shield Testing**

Protocol: A simulated network jitter will attempt to dispatch the exact same anomaly signature (identical Alert ID) twice. The system's idempotency controls must detect the collision and prevent multiple enforcement tickets.

 **Dispatch Twin Alert Signatures"**

2

INGRESS DISPATCHES

1

ENFORCEMENT TICKETS

 **Safety Verified:** 2 ingress events collapsed into 1 verified action. Mesh routing dropped 1 collision signature(s) at the edge.

ANOMALY SIGNATURE HASH

aca264f5-a411-41ed-a4fb-fe57d33b2a67

ENFORCEMENT ACTION ISSUED

```
{  "event_id": "aca264f5-a411-41ed-a4fb-fe57d33b2a67",  "correlation_id": "CAM-ISB-001",  "schema_version": 1,  "source_id": "CAM-ISB-001",  "timestamp": "2026-05-15T06:34:23.033Z",  "event_type": "SpeedViolationEvent",
```

4. 7 Envelope Fields

TRAFFIC OPS

Command Center - ISB-01

OPERATIONS

Command Center

Intersection Status

Live Alert Stream

SIMULATION & SAFETY

Alert Simulator

Duplicate Alert Safety

COMPLIANCE & DATA

Enforcement

Audit Trail

Traffic Reports

INFRASTRUCTURE

Processing Services

Capacity Monitor

System Health

API Gateway

Web Console

System Online

Live Alert Stream

Real-time ingestion of all network anomalies. Click any alert to inspect its full cryptographic metadata signature.

14 events captured

Sync Stream

Stream Log

Alert Type	Alert ID	Camera Source	Time
Speed Violation	HIGH ddd3d817-2d9b-4e7a-a6...	CAM-ISB-001	2026-05-14T12:17:55.028Z
Vehicle Detected	LOW 9f6ecb41-3d83-4ec6-a8...	CAM-ISB-001	2026-05-14T12:17:55.028Z
Speed Violation	HIGH c7e7c2b0-4953-4288-85...	CAM-ISB-001	2026-05-14T12:17:55.028Z
Speed Violation	HIGH 2a8e6327-ba64-4466-91...	CAM-ISB-001	2026-05-14T12:17:55.028Z
Speed Violation	HIGH a1a10fa5-665a-46ef-9b...	CAM-ISB-001	2026-05-14T12:17:55.028Z
Speed Violation	HIGH 784c59e5-735f-4921-ab...	CAM-ISB-001	2026-05-14T12:17:55.028Z
Speed Violation	HIGH ad5dc125-ed66-4080-90...	CAM-ISB-001	2026-05-14T12:17:55.028Z
Speed Violation	HIGH be5262b6-d7b8-4400-ad...	CAM-ISB-001	2026-05-14T12:17:55.028Z

Alert Metadata Panel

SpeedViolation

EVENT_ID

ddd3d817-2d9b-4e7a-a68d-23fb211feb74

CORRELATION_ID

bfbecc46-2513-4b31-8440-1c91ffdf892f

SCHEMA_VERSION

1

SOURCE_ID

CAM-ISB-001

TIMESTAMP

2026-05-14T12:17:55.028Z

EVENT_TYPE

SpeedViolationEvent

PAYLOAD

{
 "vehicle_plate": "ISB-5678",
 "intersection_name": "Blue Area Roundabout",
 "speed_kmh": 88,
 "speed_limit_kmh": 60
}

↑ All 7 required fields displayed

5. Observer Pattern Services

TRAFFIC OPS

Command Center - ISB-01

OPERATIONS

Command Center

Intersection Status

Live Alert Stream

SIMULATION & SAFETY

Alert Simulator

Duplicate Alert Safety

COMPLIANCE & DATA

Enforcement

Audit Trail

Traffic Reports

INFRASTRUCTURE

Processing Services

Capacity Monitor

System Health

API Gateway

Web Console

System Online

Processing Services

Live telemetry for downstream data processing micro-services hooked into the central Event Bus.

Refresh Telemetry

Service Mesh Flow

Sensors

Event Bus

AlertService

LoggingService

DashboardService

ReportingService

AlertService

Creates penalty notices for speed violations

13 PROCESSED

1 DUPES IGNORED

SUBSCRIBED EVENTS

SpeedViolation

OBSERVER PATTERN

Registered via IEventSubscriber interface. EventBus holds only the interface — never the concrete class.

LoggingService

Writes audit logs for key events

13 PROCESSED

1 DUPES IGNORED

SUBSCRIBED EVENTS

SpeedViolation

CongestionAlert

OBSERVER PATTERN

Registered via IEventSubscriber interface. EventBus holds only the interface — never the concrete class.

6. Enforcement Records

TRAFFIC OPS Command Center - ISB-01 OPERATIONS Command Center Intersection Status Live Alert Stream SIMULATION & SAFETY Alert Simulator Duplicate Alert Safety COMPLIANCE & DATA Enforcement Audit Trail Traffic Reports INFRASTRUCTURE Processing Services Capacity Monitor System Health API Gateway Web Console System Online	Enforcement Tickets Automated citations generated by the downstream Alert Service. Cryptographically deduplicated. 13 citations Refresh Index							
	STATUS	LICENSE PLATE	RECORDED SPEED	LIMIT	FINE (PKR)	CAMERA SOURCE	ANOMALY ID	TIME ISSUED
	ISSUED	ISB-5678	88 km/h	60 km/h	PKR 3,000	CAM-ISB-001	ddd3d817-2d9b-4e7a-a6...	5/14/2026, 5:17:55 PM
	ISSUED	DUP-TEST-001	95 km/h	60 km/h	PKR 5,000	CAM-ISB-001	c7e7c2b0-4953-4208-85...	5/14/2026, 5:25:08 PM
	ISSUED	DUP-TEST-001	95 km/h	60 km/h	PKR 5,000	CAM-ISB-001	2a0e6327-ba64-4466-91...	5/14/2026, 5:50:33 PM
	ISSUED	DUP-TEST-001	95 km/h	60 km/h	PKR 5,000	CAM-ISB-001	a1a10fa5-665a-46ef-9b...	5/14/2026, 5:58:12 PM
	ISSUED	DUP-TEST-001	95 km/h	60 km/h	PKR 5,000	CAM-ISB-001	704c59e5-735f-4921-ab...	5/14/2026, 6:15:14 PM
	ISSUED	DUP-TEST-001	95 km/h	60 km/h	PKR 5,000	CAM-ISB-001	ad5dc125-ed66-4080-90...	5/14/2026, 7:09:43 PM
	ISSUED	DUP-TEST-001	95 km/h	60 km/h	PKR 5,000	CAM-ISB-001	be5262b6-d7b8-4400-ad...	5/14/2026, 7:27:48 PM
	ISSUED	DUP-TEST-001	95 km/h	60 km/h	PKR 5,000	CAM-ISB-001	1c978ce0-d310-4ac4-8c...	5/14/2026, 8:35:48 PM

7. Trail Records

TRAFFIC OPS

Command Center - ISB-01

OPERATIONS

Command Center

Intersection Status

Live Alert Stream

SIMULATION & SAFETY

Alert Simulator

Duplicate Alert Safety

COMPLIANCE & DATA

Enforcement

Audit Trail

Traffic Reports

INFRASTRUCTURE

Processing Services

Capacity Monitor

System Health

API Gateway

Web Console

System Online

Audit Trail

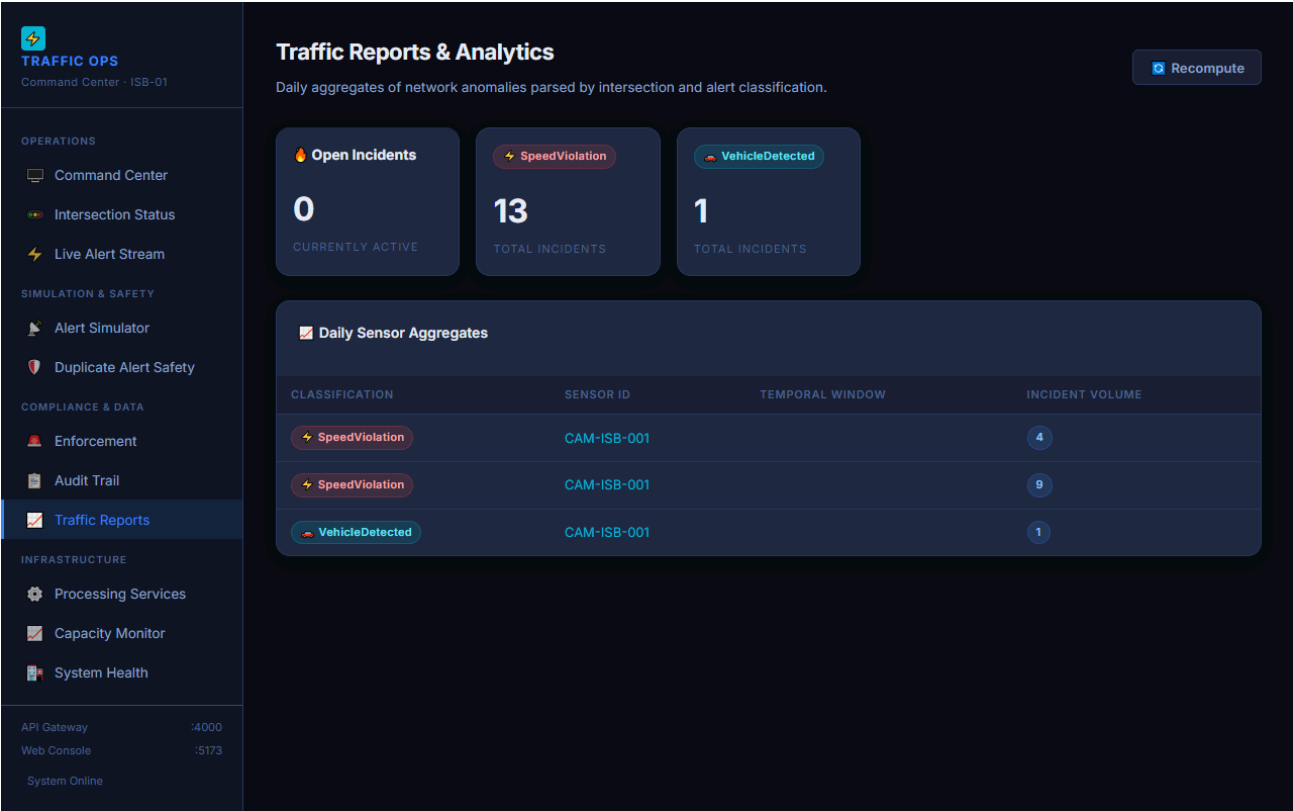
Immutable system ledger of critical network operations and enforcement decisions.

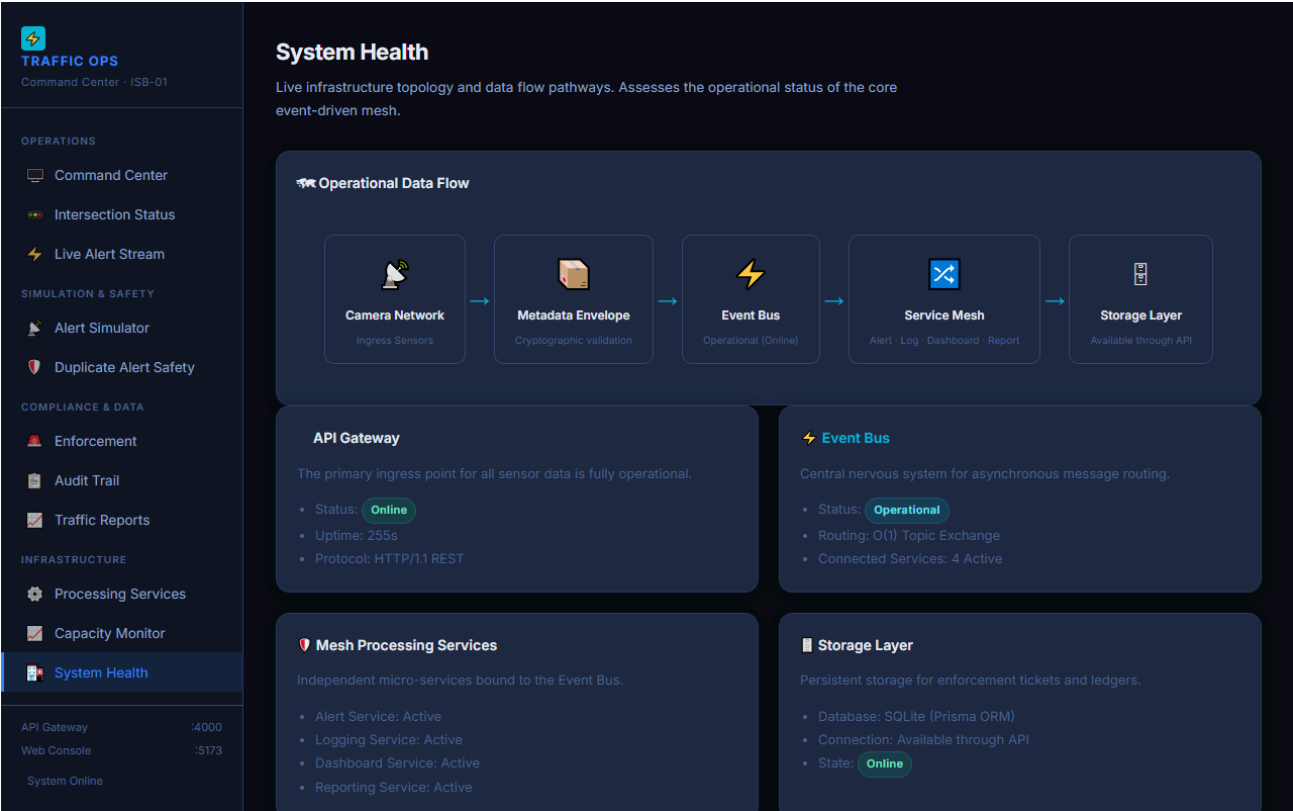
13 immutable records

Refresh Ledger

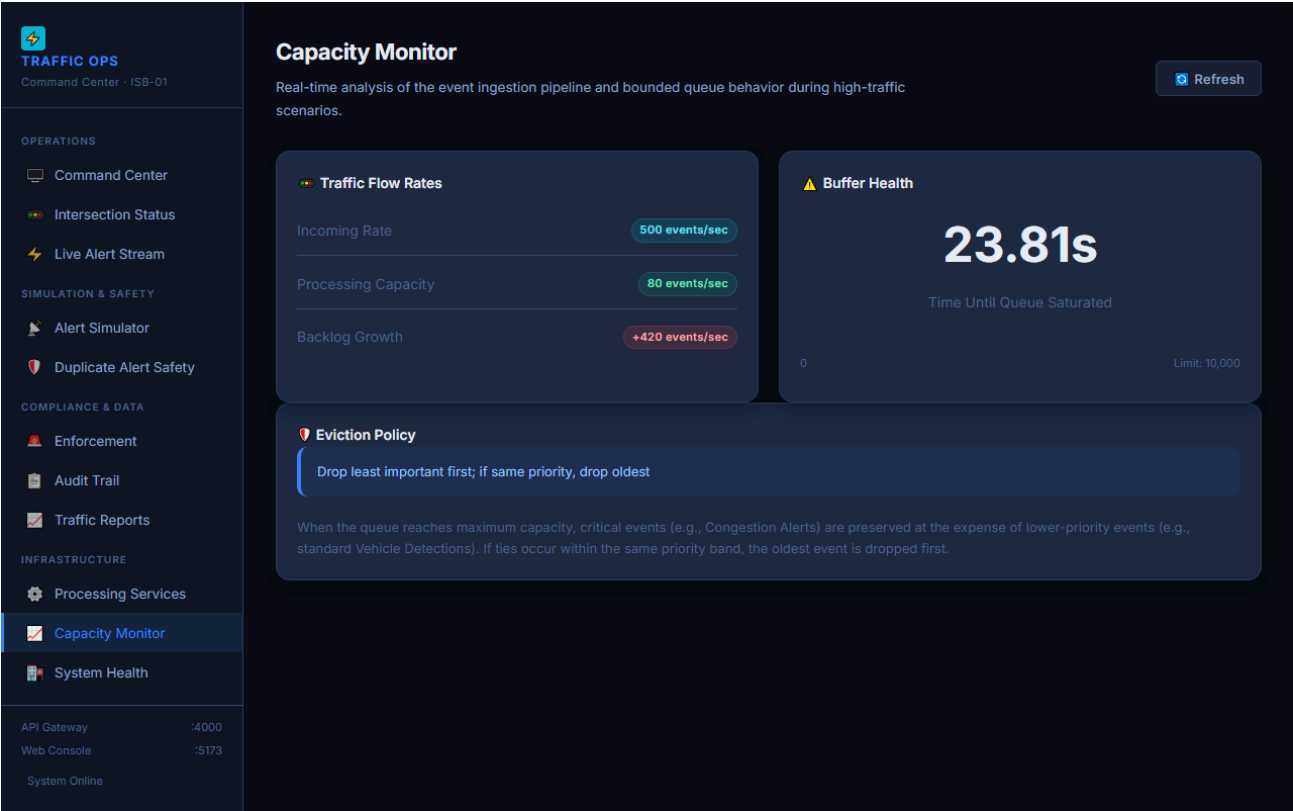
Trigger Event	Origin Anomaly ID	Audit Narrative	Ledger Timestamp
SpeedViolation	ddd3d817-2d9b-4e7a-a6...	[SpeedViolationEvent] from CAM-ISB-001 at 2026-05-14T12:17:55.028Z	5/14/2026, 5:17:55 PM
SpeedViolation	c7e7c2b0-4953-4208-85...	[SpeedViolationEvent] from CAM-ISB-001 at 2026-05-14T12:25:08.813Z	5/14/2026, 5:25:08 PM
SpeedViolation	2a0e6327-ba64-4466-91...	[SpeedViolationEvent] from CAM-ISB-001 at 2026-05-14T12:50:33.459Z	5/14/2026, 5:50:33 PM
SpeedViolation	a1a10fa5-665a-46ef-9b...	[SpeedViolationEvent] from CAM-ISB-001 at 2026-05-14T12:58:12.097Z	5/14/2026, 5:58:12 PM
SpeedViolation	704c59e5-735f-4921-ab...	[SpeedViolationEvent] from CAM-ISB-001 at 2026-05-14T13:15:14.764Z	5/14/2026, 6:15:14 PM
SpeedViolation	ad5dc125-ed66-4080-90...	[SpeedViolationEvent] from CAM-ISB-001 at 2026-05-14T14:09:43.662Z	5/14/2026, 7:09:43 PM
SpeedViolation	be5262b6-d7b8-4400-ad...	[SpeedViolationEvent] from CAM-ISB-001 at 2026-05-14T14:27:48.221Z	5/14/2026, 7:27:48 PM
SpeedViolation	1c978ce0-d310-4ac4-8c...	[SpeedViolationEvent] from CAM-ISB-001 at 2026-05-14T15:35:48.830Z	5/14/2026, 8:35:48 PM
SpeedViolation	3f5ec467-13c8-4831-b0...	[SpeedViolationEvent] from CAM-ISB-001 at 2026-05-14T15:46:51.475Z	5/14/2026, 8:46:51 PM
SpeedViolation	a7b0218a-455e-47cb-b2...	[SpeedViolationEvent] from CAM-ISB-001 at 2026-05-15T05:05:00.629Z	5/15/2026, 10:05:00 AM

8. Statistical Aggregates





11. 23.81s Bounded Queue API Proof



Appendix B: Test Output

(Verbatim from final test run)

```
✓ tests/api-routes.spec.ts (12 tests)
✓ tests/repositories.spec.ts (15 tests)
✓ tests/idempotency.spec.ts (10 tests)
✓ tests/eventbus.spec.ts (7 tests)
✓ tests/bounded-queue.spec.ts (22 tests)
✓ tests/envelope.spec.ts (9 tests)
✓ tests/fifth-event-type.spec.ts (3 tests)
```

```
Test Files  7 passed (7)
Tests      78 passed (78)
```

Appendix C: API Responses

(Selected excerpt: Bounded Queue Analysis from `GET /api/queue/analysis`)

```
{
  "incomingRate": 500,
  "processingRate": 80,
  "backlogGrowthPerSecond": 420,
  "queueLimit": 10000,
  "secondsUntilFull": 23.81,
  "evictionPolicy": "Drop least important first; if same priority, drop oldest"
}
```

(Full responses available in `docs/evidence/API_RESPONSES.md`)